

Rainforest layers

A rainforest is like a block of flats, with different residents at different layers. There are four main levels.

Emergents are the high tree tops that poke out above everything else.

The canopy is made up from the majority of the tree tops. It is a forest's leaky roof.

The understorey is made up of short trees, shade-loving plants, and lianas.

The forest floor is a thick carpet of dead leaves, ferns, and the buttresses of tree roots.

Cloud forest

In mountainous areas, rainforests may be so high that they're cloaked in clouds. The heavy moisture encourages lush plant growth.



Eastern rosella

Moth orchid

Who lives there?

All sorts of animals make the rainforest their home.

Bushbaby

Bushbabies venture out at night. Their huge eyes help them see in the dark.

These frogs eat poisonous insects, then store the poison in their skin. Their colourful patterns let other animals know that they are dangerous to eat.

Blue poison dart frog

Yellow-banded poison dart frog

Become an expert

156-157 Ecosystems
160-161 Deciduous forest

Constrictors don't have fangs or poison, so they kill prey by squeezing it to death.

Boa constrictor